

Why the Table

A sealed plate, a shared table, and a restaurant that remains what it is.

Working name: THE KOSHER OPTION ISRAEL. The name is a working name. It is not a hechsher, and it is not printed in this draft as a seal.

Prepared for the signature of David Amor and Leeya Katz.

Draft. Not yet signed.

David Amor

Leeya Katz

Date

Place



A shared table and a closed meal package. Editorial concept image; no actual restaurant or product is depicted.

No restaurant, no rabbi, and no organization was contacted in order to write this draft. Nothing in it is a partnership, announced or implied. Sorotzkin is described only as stated on their public site. The five photographic plates are AI-generated editorial concepts made with Grok on 24 September 2026. They do not show an actual restaurant, product, certificate, partner, or production process.

A companion research audit is available at `books/RESEARCH_SOURCES.md`. Every numerical claim below carries the URL and the year of the source that states it. A figure that was looked for and not found is marked as not found, and left empty.

How to read this draft

A table in Tel Aviv, on a Thursday, or on a Friday before sunset. Friends, or two people who share a home and do not share one kitchen. The room is a good room. It is not a kosher restaurant. This draft does not ask it to become one. One person at the table keeps kosher. The others want the card of the house. Today that table changes address, or it splits, or someone sits in front of a plate they do not trust. The dish this project is built to imagine is already closed when it leaves the kitchen that cooked it. The certificate on it, if the word kosher is ever used, is already the certificate of that kitchen. It arrives as one line on the menu. The rest of the table eats what the house cooks.

The draft has three parts. The first is the societal need in Israel, told only with figures that can be pointed at. The second is the Torah, limited to verses that can be quoted in full, on hospitality, on the table, and on love of one's neighbor. The third is the business: a closed line, a certificate that is already the kitchen's, and a restaurant that does not become kosher.

Three limits govern every page.

A figure is written only with a URL and a year. The share of couples who do not keep the same kashrut was not found. It is not replaced here by any neighboring percentage, including any share described elsewhere as "mixed."

A verse is written only as a real verse, named by book, chapter, and verse, in the English of *The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation* (Jewish Publication Society, 1917), checked on Sefaria on 23 September 2026. Where a Hebrew line is given, it is the Masoretic text returned with that same check, and only where the text arrived free of markup. No midrash is added. No practical ruling is derived. Questions of reheating, ovens, dishes, wine, bread, Shabbat, and Pesach are named so that they can be asked of the rabbi who holds the certificate. This draft does not answer them.

David Amor supplied the French question, “Comment apporter la Torah à la génération par amour ? Ça commence par les restaurants.” The English line in this draft, “How love brings Torah to a generation, it starts at the restaurant,” is an editorial rendering of his words. Leeya Katz has not approved or co-authored that wording in the material reviewed here. It is not a halakha, a verse, or the slogan of a certifying body.

The current market dossier and business plan use the same working name and the same refusal: the proposed pilot would buy existing sealed dishes from a supervised producer, subject to that producer's agreement and the exact certificate and handling rules. The project does not found a hechsher, does not sell one, and does

not offer a new path in kashrut. Those papers also contain working hypotheses — prices, volumes, radii, counts of pilot rooms — that have no public URL. Those hypotheses are not copied into this draft. A plan can carry a hypothesis. A memorandum that promises a source for every figure cannot.

Part I — The need in Israel

A country in which keeping kosher is ordinary speech

The need is easy to picture and easy to exaggerate. The picture is the table that cannot order one card. The exaggeration would be a precise count of such tables. That count was not found. What was found is a set of public measurements of how Jews in Israel talk about kosher food, how they describe their own religious lives, and how the catering trade is certified from district to district. Those measurements make the proposed situation plausible. They neither measure the frequency of divided tables nor establish demand for a sealed meal.

The claim of an emerging need is therefore a hypothesis. To test it, a pilot would first interview diners with different practices who actually plan meals together, then observe whether a closed option changes their choice of venue. Restaurants would have to describe service constraints in their own words, and a producer would have to test handling and food quality. A dated count of relevant enquiries, menu selections, returns, and refusals could be compared with the pilot's baseline only after a protocol and consent are agreed. No such interviews, observations, or transactions are reported in this draft. Public population and certification figures below provide context, not a substitute for those measurements.

On the eve of Rosh Hashanah 5786, the Central Bureau of Statistics estimated the population of Israel at about 10.148 million. Of the Israeli population in that estimate, about 7.758 million were "Jews and others" (78.5 percent), about 2.130 million were Arabs (21.5 percent), and about 260 thousand were foreigners. The Bureau's own note says that "others" are non-Arab Christians, members of other religions, and people with no religion classification in the Population Registry. The figure for "Jews and others" is therefore not a figure for Jews alone. The same release says the data cover about 11.75 months since the previous Rosh Hashanah, and that the population figures are provisional, based on the 2022 census. The file carries a note that data on certain pages were updated on 15 February 2026. The release itself is dated 17 September 2025.

Source: Central Bureau of Statistics, *Israel in Figures — Rosh Hashanah, Selected Annual Data 2025*, media release 304/2025, Jerusalem, 17 September 2025, [PDF](#).

The same release, in its population section for the end of 2024, says the population was more than 10 million. It estimates the population of Israelis at about 9.811 million: about 7.707 million "Jews and others" (78.6 percent of Israelis) and about 2.104 million Arabs (21.4 percent). Foreigners are estimated at about 260.9 thousand. In that same section it gives the self-defined religiosity of Jews aged 20 and over: not religious, secular, 42.7 percent; traditional, not so religious, 21.5 percent; traditional-religious, 12.0 percent; religious, 12.0 percent; Haredi, 11.4 percent. The release says the figures that follow, unless another year is stated, are for 2024. It does not, in the lines read for this draft, name a separate survey year for the religiosity row. The row is reported here as that release presents it, and not as if it were the same instrument as the Pew categories below.

Those five CBS shares describe how adults name themselves. They do not say who keeps a kosher kitchen. A person who says "secular" may keep kosher at home. A person who says "traditional" may not ask for a certificate when eating out. The names are the beginning of the map, and they are not the meal.



An imagined city restaurant at dusk. Editorial concept image, not a named location or a count of doors.

What people say they keep

The Pew Research Center's report *Israel's Religiously Divided Society* was published on 8 March 2016. Fieldwork ran from October 2014 to May 2015. In that report, Israeli Jews place themselves in four groups: Haredi, 9 percent of Jews and 8 percent of all Israeli adults; Dati, 13 percent of Jews and 10 percent of adults; Masorti, 29 percent of Jews and 23 percent of adults; Hiloni, 49 percent of Jews and 40 percent of adults.

Source: Pew Research Center, "Israel's Religiously Divided Society," 8 March 2016, [overview](#).

These four names are not the Bureau's five. The years differ. The age frames differ. This draft does not add them, and does not "update" one with the other. They are two public ways of hearing how people in Israel sort Jewish life. Both show a large secular or not-religious share, a large traditional middle, and smaller religious and Haredi shares. Both leave the kitchen undescribed until a question about food is asked.

Pew asked that question. In the chapter on Jewish beliefs and practices, the Center reports that fewer Israeli Jews say they keep kosher outside the home (52 percent) than in the home (63 percent). The practice is described as virtually universal among Haredim and Datiim, and the chart language on the same page says "All Haredim and Datiim." Among Masortim, 86 percent say they keep kosher at home. Among Hilonim, 33 percent say they keep kosher at home, and 63 percent say they do not. Outside the home, all Haredim and Datiim in the survey, and 69 percent of Masortim, say they observe kosher laws. Among Hilonim, about one in five do so. The phrase "about one in five" is Pew's. This draft does not convert it into a percentage the page does not print.

Source: Pew Research Center, "Jewish Beliefs and Practices," 8 March 2016, [chapter](#).

Two cautions belong next to these shares, because they protect the draft from a false precision.

The first caution is about subtraction. Sixty-three percent at home and fifty-two percent outside are two answers. Their difference is not, by itself, the share of people who keep kosher at home and abandon it in a restaurant. A person may answer both questions the same way. This draft does not subtract one answer from the other and call the result a kind of eater.

The second caution is about the word kosher in a survey answer. Pew explains that Jewish dietary laws include, among other practices, not eating meat and dairy together and not eating certain animal foods, including pork and shellfish. A respondent who says "I keep kosher" is reporting a self-understanding. The survey did not inspect the kitchen. The Israel Democracy Institute, in a later survey, separates "always," "usually," "only with a certificate I trust," and "by my own understanding." Those are different sentences. A business that needs one of them cannot quietly borrow another.

Pew also reports that 16 percent of Israeli Jews say they eat pork, and 82 percent say they do not. Even among Hilonim, 67 percent say they refrain from pork. Jews of Sephardi or Mizrahi ancestry are much more likely than Ashkenazi Jews to say they keep kosher outside the home (70 percent against 35 percent). Children of immigrants from the former Soviet Union are about twice as likely as their parents to keep kosher at home (50 percent against 24 percent) and outside the home (35 percent against 19 percent). The same chapter says that roughly half of Jews who speak Russian at home eat pork (47 percent) and roughly half refrain (49 percent). These lines matter because they show movement inside families and inside the category "secular," without ever counting couples who sit at one table under two standards.

The Institute's December 2024 biennial report on religion and state includes a public-opinion survey conducted in September 2024. In all, 1,211 women and men aged 18 and over were interviewed: 1,001 as a representative sample of Jewish society, and 210 as a representative sample of Arab citizens of Israel. The samples were weighted by religious self-definition, separately for Jews and Arabs, by age, and by share of the adult population. The maximum sampling error is given as 2.82 percent for the whole sample, 3.1 percent for Jews, and 6.76 percent for Arabs.

Source: Ariel Finkelstein, Ayala Goldberg, Shlomit Ravitzky Tur-Paz, and Yaari Padan, *Biennial Statistical Report on Religion and State in Israel 2024*, Israel Democracy Institute, December 2024, [PDF](#); publication page, idi.org.il/books/59047.

In that survey, 68 percent of Jews say they are careful to some degree about eating kosher food: 45 percent say they are always careful, and 23 percent say they are usually careful. The report says the 2022 biennial findings were almost identical. When the question turns to a place of eating out, the shares change shape. Of Jews, 35.5 percent say they eat only at a business that has a kashrut certificate they trust. Another 19.5 percent keep kosher according to their own understanding, or according to what the owner states, even if the business has no certificate. The remaining 45 percent do not check at all. Among secular respondents, the report says a clear majority — 85 percent — have no interest in a certificate or in a statement from the business. Among traditional respondents who are not religious, 21 percent insist on a certificate, and 44 percent keep kosher by their own understanding or by the owner's statement even without one. Among Haredi, national-religious, and traditional-religious respondents, the report describes a clear majority who eat only at a business with a certificate.

Among Jews who insist on a certificate, 47 percent say they trust any rabbinic certificate, and another 18.5 percent trust a mehadrin rabbinic or specific rabbinate. The remaining third trust only private badatz certificates, and most of that third — 23.5 percent of those who insist on a certificate — trust only specific badatz authorities. The report notes that the number of secular Jews who insist on eating only where there is a certificate is very small, so a percentage inside that cell should be read with that warning. Among Haredi respondents who eat only with a certificate, 2 percent say they trust all rabbinic certificates, and 12 percent trust specific rabbinic certificates; the preference described is for badatz supervision, and often for one badatz or a few named ones. Among national-religious respondents who eat only with a certificate, 87 percent eat where there is a rabbinic certificate: 59 percent trust all local rabbinate, and 28 percent trust mehadrin or specific rabbinate. Among traditional-religious respondents who insist on a certificate, 90.5 percent trust a rabbinic certificate: 71 percent all local rabbinate, and 19.5 percent mehadrin or specific ones. Among traditional respondents who are not religious and who require a certificate, the report says almost all trust a rabbinic certificate, most of them any local rabbinic (82 percent), and a minority a mehadrin or specific rabbinic (13.5 percent).

The same chapter asks about Tzohar's certificate, among people who insist on a certificate. Twenty-seven percent say they trust it, down from 37 percent in the 2022 survey reported in the previous biennial. The report says the Haredi public rejects Tzohar's certificate completely. Among traditional-religious respondents who insist on a certificate, 29 percent trust Tzohar, while 71 percent, in the previous breakdown, trust any rabbinic certificate. Among national-religious respondents who insist on a certificate, 59 percent trust any rabbinic certificate and 47 percent trust Tzohar. When the Institute adds the people who keep kosher by their own understanding, 51 percent of national-religious respondents say they trust Tzohar's certificate. Tzohar is an organization that exists. This project does not adopt it, does not compete with it, and does not borrow its name. The figures are here because a seal has a public, and the public does not agree.

Read together, the 2016 Pew chapter and the 2024 Institute survey say something modest and solid. A majority of Jews in Israel, on these measures, connect themselves to kosher food. A smaller share, still large, connects that practice to a certificate when eating out. A further share keeps something they call kosher without asking for a certificate. A large secular share does not ask. Inside the share that does ask, trust splits between the local rabbinic, a stricter rabbinic, and a badatz. Any plate that says "kosher" into that landscape has to say under whose certificate, or it says nothing a careful person can use.

The couple who do not keep the same kashrut

The table this project cares about is often a couple, or a family, or a pair of friends, who do not keep the same kashrut. The share of such couples was not found. It was looked for in the public sources read for this draft. It is not in the Pew chapter. It is not in the Bureau release. It is not in the Institute's kashrut chapter, which measures persons, not pairs. The companion research audit does not supply it. The market dossier in this repository already records the same gap: no figure was found for households or couples at different levels of kashrut.

That gap stays empty. It is not filled by the share of marriages across religions. It is not filled by the share of marriages across Jewish subgroups. It is not filled by any neighboring percentage a reader might have met under the label mixed.

What Pew does report, in the 2016 overview, is about spouses and friends inside the four Jewish groups. Ninety-five percent of married Haredim say their spouse is also Haredi. Ninety-three percent of Hilonim who have a spouse or partner say that person is Hiloni. Eighty-five percent of Datiim with a spouse say the spouse is Dati. Among married Masortim, 64 percent are married to another Masorti, while about one-third are married to a Jew they describe as Dati (20 percent) or Hiloni (15 percent). Nearly all Israelis in the survey who are married or living with a partner say their spouse or partner shares their religion. Two percent of married Jews say they have a spouse who belongs to a non-Jewish religion or is religiously unaffiliated. One percent of married Muslim, Christian, and Druze respondents say their spouse has a different religion.

Those are real findings, and they are findings about identity and about religion. They are not findings about kashrut inside the couple. A Hiloni married to a Hiloni can still sit across from a different kitchen: 33 percent of Hilonim say they keep kosher at home, and 63 percent say they do not. A Masorti married to a Hiloni may or may not keep the same table; the survey does not ask. Friendships tell a similar story of social separation without answering the food question. Only about half of Masortim (48 percent) say that all or most of their close friends are also Masortim. Among Haredim and Hilonim, roughly nine in ten say all or most of their close friends belong to the same Jewish subgroup. Among Datiim, 72 percent say all or most of their close friends are Datiim.

The need, stated honestly, is therefore this. The surveys show many people who keep kosher, many people who do not, and a great deal of shared life inside the secular and traditional majority. They do not show how often two people who love each other, or who simply want the same evening, fail to keep the same kashrut. Anyone who offers a percentage for that failure, on the strength of these pages, is inventing it. This draft declines.

The scene can still be described, because description is not a rate. A person who keeps kosher outside the home cannot eat the card of a non-kosher restaurant. Pew's 52 percent is the share who say they keep kosher outside, not the share who will accept any particular seal in any particular room. The Institute's 35.5 percent, in September 2024, is the share who say they eat out only where a certificate they trust is present. Some of those people will not sit in a non-kosher room at all, whatever is sealed on the table. The Institute's own breakdown says as much: a Haredi respondent who insists on a certificate is, in that survey, very unlikely to trust a general rabbinic certificate, let alone a dish served in a room that has none. The person for whom a sealed plate in a secular bistro is even a candidate is a narrower person than "anyone who keeps kosher." The working papers in this repository already say that the guest in view is someone for whom the rabbinic certificate is already enough at home, and that a badatz public will usually refuse the room. This draft repeats that limit. It does not soften it with a market percentage it does not have.



Two chairs at an ordinary table. Editorial concept image; no actual diner is represented.

A city where certification of the catering trade is partial

Tel Aviv comes first in the working papers because it is a secular dining city, dense with rooms that are not kosher, and because a single morning delivery can reach a cluster of them. That is a choice of where to begin. It is not a census.

A current count of non-kosher restaurants in the city of Tel Aviv was not found for this draft. The market dossier says the same: the count of rooms lives, if it lives, in a survey folder that is not this memorandum. What the Israel Democracy Institute does publish is older, and it is about a district and a trade, not about a street.

In the 2024 biennial, religious councils are reported to have issued kashrut certificates to 14,423 businesses in 2022, a rise of 5.4 percent from 13,683 businesses in 2020. Of the 2022 certificates, catering and hospitality account for 8,400 businesses, 58 percent. Food manufacturing accounts for 25 percent, and food retail for 17 percent. Of all those kosher businesses, 43.5 percent are in the center of the country: 26.5 percent in the Central district and 17 percent in the Tel Aviv district. The South accounts for 17 percent, and Jerusalem with Judea and Samaria for 16 percent. These are shares of the kosher stock. They are not the share of all businesses that are kosher.

On that second question the report is careful. It says the Bureau's economic classification does not match the religious councils' classification, so a precise rate by branch and district is hard. It then reports a special analysis, done earlier with the Bureau, of kosher businesses in 2019. On that analysis, one may estimate that about 66 percent of catering businesses in Israel — cafés, restaurants, and food stands — are kosher. The chart in the 2024 report is titled as the share of kosher businesses in the catering branch (restaurants, cafés, and food stands) by geographic district, for 2019. The highest share is in the Jerusalem and Judea and Samaria district, where 90 percent of catering businesses are kosher. In the Tel Aviv district, 49 percent of catering businesses are kosher. The report ties the contrast to the more traditional religious profile of the Jerusalem district and the more secular profile of the Tel Aviv district. It also notes that a restaurant or café

open on Shabbat cannot, as things stand, receive a certificate from a local rabbinate, unlike a hotel. The footnote points back to Ariel Finkelstein and Gabriel Abensour, *The Kashrut System in Israel: A Data Review*, Israel Democracy Institute, 2021.

Forty-nine percent is a 2019 share of a district's catering trade, republished in 2024. It is not a 2026 count of doors on a Tel Aviv street. It is enough to refuse two slogans. It refuses "Tel Aviv has no kosher food," because on this measure about half the catering trade in the district held a certificate. It refuses "the non-kosher room is a rarity," because a 49 percent kosher share means certification is partial. The report does not print a separate line for the complementary share, and this draft does not invent one. Partial is the word the figure supports.

The same report describes Shabbat opening hours for culture and commerce, checked in a way that shows the city's week. It is not a restaurant survey, and it is not used here as one. In the Tel Aviv district, 23 cultural halls and theaters, 79 percent of those in the district, were found open on Shabbat. All 11 recognized museums in the Tel Aviv district were open on Shabbat. Of 31 swimming pools in the district, 97 percent were open on Shabbat, which the report glosses as a single pool closed. The checks are those of the 2024 report, with the museum and pool findings stated for the district pattern the authors describe. A room that serves lunch on Saturday is, in this city, an ordinary commercial fact. A kosher kitchen certified by a local rabbinate does not follow that fact. The project's working papers therefore withhold the sealed line on Saturday. That withholding is an operating decision of the draft, pending a written rule from the rabbi of whatever certificate is in question. It is not a ruling invented here about what Shabbat permits.

What people already do, and what is still missing

When a table cannot share one card, the substitutes already exist. They are named here without a volume, because no sourced volume was found.

The observant person can choose a kosher restaurant. The table then either moves there, and the others eat in a room they did not choose, or it splits, and the evening becomes two addresses. The person can eat at home, or bring a dish from home. A certified kitchen can deliver to the house. OU Kosher's guide to travel meals describes a further pattern already in use: certified meals carried by planes, trains, and ships, heated while double wrapped, with the caterer's and certifier's seals intact. The guide says the certification covers only the food in the sealed package; loose bread, wine, and other food served by the carrier are not included. It does not grant this project permission to use a restaurant oven. The proposed dish would require a separate written procedure from the supervising rabbi for its exact product, package, and service. The precedent shows an object, not an approval of this business.

Source for the travel-meal description: *OU Kosher, The Kosher Primer*, travel section, checked 24 September 2026.

The missing object is narrow. It is a way to remain at this table, in this non-kosher room, with a dish whose certificate was earned in a kitchen that already has one. The room does not change its name. The guest who needs the certificate does not have to leave, and does not have to pretend the salad, the bread, the wine, or the dessert of the house are covered. Friends who do not keep kosher order the card they came for. Whether

enough such tables exist to carry a business is not answered by the 63 percent, the 52 percent, the 35.5 percent, or the 49 percent. Those figures show a public and a city in which the problem is intelligible. They do not show a forecast. This draft does not add one.

Part II — Torah: hospitality, the table, and love of one's neighbor

What a verse is allowed to do here

This part quotes verses. It says what they say. It stops where a ruling would begin.

The quotations are from the 1917 Jewish Publication Society translation, a public-domain text, as served by Sefaria for the version titled *The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917)*. Each quotation was checked on 23 September 2026. The citation under each block is the citation. If a verse was not in that check, it is not in this part. Rabbinic expansion — what later law made of a kid and its mother's milk, what later law required of a stove, a seal, or a Gentile cook — is real in Jewish life and is not retold here. Retelling it would be a ruling, or a textbook of rulings, and this draft is neither. Where a verse is followed, in the tradition, by a famous story that is not the verse, the story is left out. The reader who knows the story will notice the silence. The silence is the method.

Hospitality, in these verses, is a run toward the guest, a drink of water, a bed, a morsel, a place at a meal. The table, in these verses, is a furnished thing: a surface set before a person, a ring of children, a dinner where love is, a room with a table in it for the traveler. Love of one's neighbor, in these verses, is a command in Leviticus, repeated toward the stranger, and joined to bread for the hungry and to an open door. None of these verses names a restaurant in Tel Aviv. None of them says that a commercial sealed plate fulfills the command. The verses are here because David Amor asks whether love can bring Torah to a generation, beginning in restaurants. The verses have to be real, so that his question can sit beside them without being mistaken for scripture.

Abraham at the tent

Genesis 18:2. and he lifted up his eyes and looked, and, lo, three men stood over against him; and when he saw them, he ran to meet them from the tent door, and bowed down to the earth,

Genesis 18:3. and said: 'My lord, if now I have found favour in thy sight, pass not away, I pray thee, from thy servant.

Genesis 18:4. Let now a little water be fetched, and wash your feet, and recline yourselves under the tree.

Genesis 18:5. And I will fetch a morsel of bread, and stay ye your heart; after that ye shall pass on; forasmuch as ye are come to your servant.' And they said: 'So do, as thou hast said.'

Genesis 18:6. And Abraham hastened into the tent unto Sarah, and said: 'Make ready quickly three measures of fine meal, knead it, and make cakes.'

Genesis 18:7. And Abraham ran unto the herd, and fetched a calf tender and good, and gave it unto the servant; and he hastened to dress it.

Genesis 18:8. And he took curd, and milk, and the calf which he had dressed, and set it before them; and he stood by them under the tree, and they did eat.

Genesis 18:2; Genesis 18:3; Genesis 18:4; Genesis 18:5; Genesis 18:6; Genesis 18:7; Genesis 18:8. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

The scene, in the words just quoted, is speed and food. He runs. He asks them not to pass. He offers a little water, a washing of feet, a rest under the tree, a morsel of bread. He hastens to Sarah for cakes. He runs to the herd for a tender calf and gives it to the servant to prepare. He takes curd, and milk, and the calf, and sets them before the guests. He stands by them under the tree, and they eat.

That is the verse. A later reader hears, in the curd and the milk and the calf together, a question that the laws of meat and milk will press. This draft does not answer it. It does not say the verse permits a later table to mix meat and milk. It does not import a story in which the guests did not really eat, or ate only one of the foods, or in which the foods were timed apart. Those stories are not these verses. Genesis 18:8 says he set curd, and milk, and the calf before them, and they ate. The sentences about a kid and its mother's milk are quoted later, where they stand in Exodus and Deuteronomy. How far those sentences reach is halakhah. It is not decided on this page.

What the scene does support, as a plain reading, is the posture of a host. The host moves first. The meal is made for people who were passing. The host stands while they eat. He calls the meal a morsel and then hurries a much larger preparation. None of that is a menu specification. It is the reason a project about a shared table is willing to be judged by whether the person who cannot eat the card is still a guest, and not an obstacle the evening has to route around.

Lot, Rebekah, and a meal that is urged

Genesis 19:1. And the two angels came to Sodom at even; and Lot sat in the gate of Sodom; and Lot saw them, and rose up to meet them; and he fell down on his face to the earth;

Genesis 19:2. and he said: 'Behold now, my lords, turn aside, I pray you, into your servant's house, and tarry all night, and wash your feet, and ye shall rise up early, and go on your way.' And they said: 'Nay; but we will abide in the broad place all night.'

Genesis 19:3. And he urged them greatly; and they turned in unto him, and entered into his house; and he made them a feast, and did bake unleavened bread, and they did eat.

Genesis 19:1; Genesis 19:2; Genesis 19:3. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Lot, in these three verses, rises, bows, and presses the travelers to come in, to wash, to stay the night, and then to go on in the morning. They would have stayed in the square. He urges them, and they turn in. He makes them a feast and bakes unleavened bread, and they eat. The chapter goes on, beyond these verses, into violence this draft does not retell and does not use. The meal verses are cited because they show hospitality as insistence: the guest who would have remained outside is brought in and fed. They are not cited as a story about Sodom's punishment, and they are not a model for a restaurant's floor plan.

Genesis 24:17. And the servant ran to meet her, and said: 'Give me to drink, I pray thee, a little water of thy pitcher.'

Genesis 24:18. And she said: 'Drink, my lord'; and she hastened, and let down her pitcher upon her hand, and gave him drink.

Genesis 24:19. And when she had done giving him drink, she said: 'I will draw for thy camels also, until they have done drinking.'

Genesis 24:17; Genesis 24:18; Genesis 24:19. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Rebekah's answer is shorter than Abraham's table and just as complete. Asked for a little water, she says "Drink, my lord," and she hastens. When he has drunk, she draws for the camels until they have finished. The verse is about water, and about not stopping at the first request. A sealed plate that covers only itself, and leaves the bread and the wine of the house outside the seal, has to be as clear as her second sentence. The first kindness is not allowed to blur into a second kindness the kitchen did not give.

A table the house has already divided

Genesis 43:32. And they set on for him by himself, and for them by themselves, and for the Egyptians, that did eat with him, by themselves; because the Egyptians might not eat bread with the Hebrews; for that is an abomination unto the Egyptians.

Genesis 43:32. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Joseph's brothers are in his house. Food is served. It is served apart: for him by himself, for them by themselves, and for the Egyptians who ate with him by themselves, because the Egyptians might not eat bread with the Hebrews. The verse calls that separation an abomination to the Egyptians. It does not call it a virtue, and it does not call it a halakhah for Israel. It records a rule, held by the hosts, that splits one room into three eatings.

A Tel Aviv bistro is not Egypt, and this draft does not say it is. The verse is here because the Torah already knows a meal at which people share a roof and do not share a food. The evening can be ruined by pretending the rule is not there. It can also be ruined by sending one person out so that the others may forget the rule. The closed line is an attempt to let the rule of the dish stay written on the dish, and the rule of the house stay written on the house, in the same room. Genesis 43:32 does not authorize that attempt. It only makes the split visible, so that a later practical arrangement cannot claim the Torah has never seen one.

The neighbor, the stranger, and the door

Leviticus 19:18. Thou shalt not take vengeance, nor bear any grudge against the children of thy people, but thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself: I am the LORD.

Leviticus 19:18. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

The Hebrew of the same verse, as returned with the English:

לֹא-תִקֶּם וְלֹא-תִטֹּר אֶת-כְּנִי עִמָּךְ וְאֶהְבֶּתָּ לְרֵעֶךָ כְּמוֹדְךָ אָנֹכִי יְהוָה:

The command sits after a refusal of vengeance and of a grudge against the children of one's people. Love of neighbor is not a mood added to the verse. It is the verse's positive sentence, and it is sealed with "I am the LORD." This draft does not reduce it to a feeling about restaurants. It also does not expand it into a claim that serving a sealed plate is the performance of the command. The command is wider than a menu, and a menu is not its measure. What the command will not allow, if one is listening, is a shrug at the person beside you whose plate has been made impossible. Love of neighbor, in the words of the verse, is "as thyself." A table arranged only for the people who can eat anything on it has not yet asked that question.

The same chapter, a few verses earlier, ties food in a field to the poor and the stranger.

Leviticus 19:9. And when ye reap the harvest of your land, thou shalt not wholly reap the corner of thy field, neither shalt thou gather the gleanings of thy harvest.

Leviticus 19:10. And thou shalt not glean thy vineyard, neither shalt thou gather the fallen fruit of thy vineyard; thou shalt leave them for the poor and for the stranger: I am the LORD your God.

Leviticus 19:9; Leviticus 19:10. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

The corner, the gleanings, and the fallen fruit are left. The draft does not turn a commercial deli into gleanings. It records that Leviticus puts food and the stranger in the same chapter as love of neighbor. The person who keeps kosher in a secular city is not, by that fact, the poor of this verse. Using Isaiah's hungry, or Leviticus's gleaners, as a marketing picture of the guest would be a misuse. The verses are quoted so that the misuse is harder, not easier.

Leviticus 19:33. And if a stranger sojourn with thee in your land, ye shall not do him wrong.

Leviticus 19:34. The stranger that sojourneth with you shall be unto you as the home-born among you, and thou shalt love him as thyself; for ye were strangers in the land of Egypt: I am the LORD your God.

Leviticus 19:33; Leviticus 19:34. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Exodus 23:9. And a stranger shalt thou not oppress; for ye know the heart of a stranger, seeing ye were strangers in the land of Egypt.

Exodus 23:9. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Deuteronomy 10:18. He doth execute justice for the fatherless and widow, and loveth the stranger, in giving him food and raiment.

Deuteronomy 10:19. Love ye therefore the stranger; for ye were strangers in the land of Egypt.

Deuteronomy 10:18; Deuteronomy 10:19. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

The Hebrew of Deuteronomy 10:19:

וְאָהַבְתֶּם אֶת־הַגֵּר כִּי־גֵרִים הָיִיתֶם בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם:

The stranger is not to be wronged, not to be oppressed, and is to be loved as the home-born. The reason given is memory: you were strangers in Egypt. Deuteronomy 10:18 says that God loves the stranger, in giving him food and raiment. The human command in the next verse follows that divine act. Food is one of the two things named. Again the draft stops. A sealed plate sold at a restaurant price is not "giving him food" in the sense of this verse, and it is not claimed to be. The verse does make it hard to speak of hospitality while arranging that the person with a stricter table should eat somewhere else, out of sight, as the cost of everyone else's convenience.

Job states the same door from the other side of the sentence, as a protest of innocence.

Job 31:32. The stranger did not lodge in the street; My doors I opened to the roadside.

Job 31:32. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

The Hebrew:

בְּחַיִּי לֹא־יָלִין גֵּר דְּלֹתִי לְאַרְחָא אֶפְתָּח:

Isaiah, in the chapter on the fast God wants, names bread and a house.

Isaiah 58:7. Is it not to deal thy bread to the hungry, And that thou bring the poor that are cast out to thy house? When thou seest the naked, that thou cover him, And that thou hide not thyself from thine own flesh?

Isaiah 58:7. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Micah gathers justice, love of mercy, and a humble walk.

Micah 6:8. It hath been told thee, O man, what is good, And what the LORD doth require of thee: Only to do justly, and to love mercy, and to walk humbly with thy God.

Micah 6:8. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

These three verses are not a business plan. Job's open door is a lodging. Isaiah's bread is for the hungry, and the poor who are cast out are to be brought into the house; the prophet also says not to hide from one's own flesh. Micah's mercy is paired with justice, not with a product. A generation that hears "love" only as warmth, and never as these sentences, has not yet heard the chapter. A project that prints "love" on a lid, and has not left the neighbor able to eat beside the people he loves, has not yet heard it either. The sealed line is small next to Isaiah. It is allowed to be small. It is not allowed to borrow the prophet's voice.

Tables: a proverb, a psalm, a field, a feast

Proverbs 15:17. Better is a dinner of herbs where love is, Than a stalled ox and hatred therewith.

Proverbs 15:17. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

The Hebrew:

A dinner of herbs where love is, set over a stalled ox where hatred is. The proverb is the verse in this draft that comes closest to David Amor's question, and it is not his sentence. The proverb does not mention a restaurant. It does not mention a generation. It does not mention Torah's transmission. It prefers a modest meal where love is to a rich meal where hatred is. David's question asks whether love can carry Torah to a generation, beginning in restaurants. Both can be true in a conversation. Only one of them is a verse. The proverb is quoted in full so that David's words cannot hide inside it.

Psalms 23:5. Thou preparest a table before me in the presence of mine enemies; Thou hast anointed my head with oil; my cup runneth over.

Psalms 23:5. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Psalms 128:3. Thy wife shall be as a fruitful vine, in the innermost parts of thy house; Thy children like olive plants, round about thy table.

Psalms 128:3. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Psalm 23:5 is a table prepared in the presence of enemies, a head anointed, a cup running over. It is not a restaurant reservation, and the enemies in the line are not the secular friends at a Tel Aviv table. To cast the friends as the "enemies" of the verse would be a violence against both the psalm and the evening. The line is here because "table" in the Torah and in the Writings is a place where a person is sustained in the sight of others, not a metaphor invented for a brand. Psalm 128:3 places children like olive plants round about the table, and a wife like a fruitful vine in the house. It is a picture of a household table. The project's table is often a household that has gone out, or a friendship that wants one address. The psalm does not describe a bistro. It does describe a table as the place where a family is visible together. A split address is the loss of that visibility, even when both addresses are kind.

Ruth 2:14. And Boaz said unto her at meal-time: 'Come hither, and eat of the bread, and dip thy morsel in the vinegar.' And she sat beside the reapers; and they reached her parched corn, and she did eat and was satisfied, and left thereof.

Ruth 2:14. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Boaz, at meal-time, tells Ruth to come and eat of the bread and dip her morsel. She sits beside the reapers. They reach her parched corn. She eats, is satisfied, and leaves some. The meal is in a field, among workers, and the invitation is specific: come, eat this. It is not an invitation to the whole of someone else's store. A closed dish on a mixed table has the same narrowness, if it is honest. Come, eat this. The rest of the card is not yours, and it is not offered as if it were.

Deuteronomy 16:14. And thou shalt rejoice in thy feast, thou, and thy son, and thy daughter, and thy manservant, and thy maid-servant, and the Levite, and the stranger, and the fatherless, and the widow, that are within thy gates.

Deuteronomy 16:14. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

The feast of rejoicing names a long list of who is inside the gates: you, your son, your daughter, the servant, the Levite, the stranger, the fatherless, the widow. The verse is about a feast, not about a Tuesday lunch. It is the Torah's wide table, and it includes the stranger in the rejoicing. A project that serves only people who already agree would be smaller than this verse. A project that serves them by erasing the dietary verses quoted next would not be this verse either. The list is an inclusion. It is not a cancellation of the distinctions the Torah also writes.

Deuteronomy 8:10. And thou shalt eat and be satisfied, and bless the LORD thy God for the good land which He hath given thee.

Deuteronomy 8:10. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Eat, be satisfied, and bless. The verse is the one Jewish grace after meals takes as its scriptural ground. This draft does not teach the grace, does not fix its text, and does not say who must say it over a sealed plate. It quotes the verse because a table, in this line, ends in thanks for the land, not only in consumption. On the public about-page of Sorotzkin, read on 23 September 2026, a line appears that plays on this verse and is not this verse. Their wording is recorded in Part III, and it is kept separate from Deuteronomy 8:10.

A room with a table, and a little cake first

II Kings 4:8. And it fell on a day, that Elisha passed to Shunem, where was a great woman; and she constrained him to eat bread. And so it was, that as oft as he passed by, he turned in thither to eat bread.

II Kings 4:9. And she said unto her husband: 'Behold now, I perceive that this is a holy man of God, that passeth by us continually.

II Kings 4:10. Let us make, I pray thee, a little chamber on the roof; and let us set for him there a bed, and a table, and a stool, and a candlestick; and it shall be, when he cometh to us, that he shall turn in thither.'

II Kings 4:8; II Kings 4:9; II Kings 4:10. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

The woman of Shunem constrains Elisha to eat bread, and he turns in whenever he passes. She tells her husband that this is a holy man of God. She asks for a small roof-chamber, and for a bed, a table, a stool, and a candlestick, so that when he comes he may turn in there. The table in the verse is furniture in a room kept for a guest whose life is not the life of the house. The house does not become the guest. The guest is given a place that is his when he is there. A sealed dish is a much smaller hospitality than a chamber. The likeness, and it is only a likeness, is that the house remains the house, and the guest's need is furnished rather than debated.

I Kings 17:12. And she said: 'As the LORD thy God liveth, I have not a cake, only a handful of meal in the jar, and a little oil in the cruse; and, behold, I am gathering two sticks, that I may go in and dress it for me and my son, that we may eat it, and die.'

I Kings 17:13. And Elijah said unto her: ‘Fear not; go and do as thou hast said; but make me thereof a little cake first, and bring it forth unto me, and afterward make for thee and for thy son.

I Kings 17:15. And she went and did according to the saying of Elijah; and she, and he, and her house, did eat many days.

I Kings 17:12; I Kings 17:13; I Kings 17:15. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

The widow of Zarephath has a handful of meal and a little oil, and she is gathering two sticks so that she and her son may eat and die. Elijah asks for a little cake first. She goes and does as he said, and she, and he, and her house eat many days. The miracle in the following verses is not quoted, because this draft does not need it and will not turn it into a promise of supply. What is quoted is the sharing of the last prepared food, and the order of the ask. It is a poor woman's table, not a wholesale account. To use her as the mascot of a paid line would be indecent. She is here because hospitality in the Torah is sometimes the food one barely has. The commercial plate has to be excellent for a different reason: a guest who pays, in a room he chose for pleasure, is not asked to accept a lesser thing as the price of his observance. The widow's story sets a floor on seriousness. It does not set a price.

What the dietary verses say, and where they stop

Leviticus 11:2. Speak unto the children of Israel, saying: These are the living things which ye may eat among all the beasts that are on the earth.

Leviticus 11:2. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Leviticus 11:46. This is the law of the beast, and of the fowl, and of every living creature that moveth in the waters, and of every creature that swarmeth upon the earth;

Leviticus 11:47. to make a difference between the unclean and the clean, and between the living thing that may be eaten and the living thing that may not be eaten.

Leviticus 11:46; Leviticus 11:47. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Deuteronomy 14:3. Thou shalt not eat any abominable thing.

Deuteronomy 14:3. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Leviticus 11 opens, in the verse quoted, by telling Israel which living things may be eaten among the beasts of the earth. It closes, in the two verses quoted, by calling the chapter a teaching that distinguishes unclean from clean, and the creature that may be eaten from the creature that may not. Deuteronomy 14:3 is the short prohibition: you shall not eat any abominable thing. The long lists between Leviticus 11:2 and 11:46, and between Deuteronomy 14:3 and 14:21, are not copied out here. They are in the book. This draft does not

need to rehearse every species in order to admit that the Torah itself distinguishes foods. A restaurant card that ignores the distinction is intelligible as a secular card. It is not intelligible as a fulfillment of these verses. A sealed dish that claims the distinction has to be telling the truth under a certificate, not under a mood.

The sentence about a kid and its mother's milk stands three times.

Exodus 23:19. The choicest first-fruits of thy land thou shalt bring into the house of the LORD thy God. Thou shalt not seethe a kid in its mother's milk.

Exodus 23:19. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Exodus 34:26. The choicest first-fruits of thy land thou shalt bring unto the house of the LORD thy God. Thou shalt not seethe a kid in its mother's milk.'

Exodus 34:26. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Deuteronomy 14:21. Ye shall not eat of any thing that dieth of itself; thou mayest give it unto the stranger that is within thy gates, that he may eat it; or thou mayest sell it unto a foreigner; for thou art a holy people unto the LORD thy God. Thou shalt not seethe a kid in its mother's milk.

Deuteronomy 14:21. The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917), checked on Sefaria, 23 September 2026.

Each time, the words "Thou shalt not seethe a kid in its mother's milk" are in the verse. Exodus 23:19 and Exodus 34:26 place that sentence after the first-fruits. Deuteronomy 14:21 places it after a rule about an animal that dies of itself, which may be given to the stranger or sold to a foreigner, and after the sentence "for thou art a holy people unto the LORD thy God." This draft quotes all three because a single quotation might look chosen for an argument. Together they are the Torah's repetition. What the repetition prohibits, in the words on the page, is seething a kid in its mother's milk. Jewish law, over centuries, built a wide practice of separating meat and milk from this sentence and from the traditions that read it. That wide practice is how millions of Jews keep kosher, including many of the people in the surveys of Part I. This draft does not re-enact the legal arguments, does not decide their extent, and does not tell a kitchen how to arrange its boards. If a kitchen holds a certificate, the certificate's body has already accepted a practice. The plate carries that body's name. The memorandum does not substitute itself for the body.

Deuteronomy 14:21 also speaks of giving a carcass to the stranger. That line is not a permission, invented here, to serve non-kosher food to a guest and call it love. The verse is a verse about a carcass and about a holy people. It is quoted because it is in the same verse as the kid. A reader who wants only the kid can find it in Exodus without this extra sentence. Leaving the extra sentence in is part of refusing to edit the Torah down to a brochure.

David's question, after the verses

The verses above are the Torah's. What follows is not.

How love brings Torah to a generation, it starts at the restaurant.

David Amor supplied the French question behind this provisional English rendering. It is not attributed to Leeya Katz pending her review. It is not Leviticus 19:18 or Proverbs 15:17, not a halakha about where a generation learns, and not a claim that a restaurant is a synagogue or a school. It asks whether transmission can begin at the table where people already are, if love is the reason someone makes room for another person.

"Possible," in this project, has a plain meaning. The person who keeps kosher is not asked to break it in order to stay. The person who does not keep it is not asked to pretend the whole room has changed. Love, in David's question, is the will that both people remain. Torah is what the one who keeps it still keeps, in public, beside the other. The restaurant is the place the project asks them to share. None of that is proved by a verse number. The verses make it discussable. The wording remains David's proposal; the signature lines are empty.



A reading table under an olive tree. Editorial concept image; the pictured page is not a quotation from scripture.

Part III — The business

The closed line

The business is a line on a menu.

The proposed pilot starts with an existing producer, not a kitchen built for this project. If its current certificate covers the exact dish and the new route is approved, the dish would leave that kitchen closed. A restaurant that is not kosher would store it according to the producer's instructions, serve it under an approved protocol, and leave every other line alone. The guest who keeps kosher would decide whether this product and its supervision suit them. Friends could order the house's food. Sorotzkin's public FAQ describes direct delivery to households, with no physical shop; it does not describe this proposed restaurant channel. THE KOSHER OPTION ISRAEL is a working name, not a seal. Any menu wording must first be approved by Israeli counsel, the producer, and the relevant certifying authority; this draft supplies no ready-to-print line.

"Closed" means the seal is intact until the guest opens it, or until it is opened where the guest can see. A seal broken in the restaurant's kitchen removes that dish from the proposed kosher option. It is isolated and documented, not rescued with the house's ingredients, replated onto the house's china, or served under the word kosher. Return or disposal must follow a signed incident procedure; neither is automatic. This is a proposed operating rule, not a psak. A rabbi who supervises the kitchen may write a stricter rule, or may refuse the whole service of a sealed dish in a non-kosher room. If that rabbi refuses, the project stops.

The dish is designed to be eaten from its own container, unless the rabbi of the certificate has written some other handling. The house's plates do not receive this food on the strength of this draft. The house's oven does not receive it either, unless that same rabbi has written that a closed container may be warmed, and how. Until such a writing exists, the operating rule is that the oven of the restaurant does not touch the dish. OU Kosher's description of double-wrapped travel meals, cited in Part I, is a description of another supervised practice. It is not a letter from the rabbi of this kitchen. There is, today, no such letter in this project, because no rabbi has been asked. Service without reheating also requires the producer's safe serving-temperature instructions for the specific dish.

Wine, bread, salad, and dessert from the card are outside the seal. They are not covered by the certificate of the dish. The guest who needs them to be covered brings them, or does without. The kitchen does not complete the container from the restaurant's station. A visible seal is a condition of the product. A dish that can pass as an ordinary plate, with the certificate hidden in the kitchen, is a different product, and it is not this one. People will see the container. The draft accepts that. Hiding would be the deception the statute, quoted below, exists to prevent.

Shabbat is withheld. Restaurants in the city are often open on Saturday, as the cultural figures in Part I suggest for museums, pools, and halls, and as anyone who walks the city can see for dining rooms. This draft does not convert that fact into a rate of restaurants open on Shabbat, because that rate was not found. It does say that the sealed line, in the working papers, does not exist on Saturday, and does not exist on Friday after the hour the rabbi of the certificate sets. There is no production by the project on Shabbat, no delivery, and no

reheating operated by the project. The restaurant serves its own card. The line returns on a weekday, on a dish that arrived before. Pesach is withheld in the same spirit. This draft does not treat an ordinary certificate as a Pesach certificate. If the certificate does not say Pesach, the line is not sold as food for Pesach. That is a refusal to invent a status. It is not a ruling about what Pesach requires.

Questions left with the rabbi of the certificate, and not answered here, include: whether anyone other than the producing kitchen may finish the cooking; what happens to wine and bread that are not in the container; whether immersion of a vessel is required for the container this kitchen uses; and whether any Shabbat reheating, by the restaurant's staff, could ever be written down as permitted. Until they are written by that rabbi, the operating rules above stay in force. A lawyer's question is separate, and it is stated with the statute.



A plain closed meal package with a tamper-evident strip. Editorial concept image; it bears no certificate and cannot stand in for one.

The certificate is already the kitchen's

The project does not certify. The sentence is the whole of the corporate idea.

A plate may be called kosher, in public, only when a certificate that already exists covers it, and only while that certificate is true. The kitchen is the manufacturer. The certificate is the one given for that kitchen's production by a body the law recognizes and the guest can name. The restaurant is a place where the plate is held and served. It does not receive, through this service, a certificate for its room, its oven, its staff, or its card.

The current working plan names an existing deli, Sorotzkin / Jewish Deli, as a *candidate supplier*, rather than proposing a new kitchen. Its public FAQ says the deli is supervised by the Petah Tikva Rabbinat. The project has not obtained the current certificate, established which specific dishes it covers, or received the deli's or its rabbi's approval for service through a non-kosher restaurant. No supply is signed. The certificate, if the plan becomes possible, must be the producer's valid certificate for the actual product and route; it cannot be inferred from a website sentence or transferred to the restaurant.

The applicable statute is *חוק איסור הונאה בכשרות, התשמ"ג-1983*, the Kashrut Fraud Prohibition Law, 5743–1983. The Knesset's official law record lists Amendment No. 5, published on 19 July 2026. That amendment removed the private-body certification framework and changed the list of authorized certificate issuers. The numbered provisions below are a research reading of the amended statute, not an opinion on this particular service. Transitional provisions and their dates must be checked in the official text before any certificate or menu claim is used.

Primary sources: [Knesset national legislation record for the 1983 law and Amendment No. 5](#), and the [Knesset's announcement of the amendment's final passage](#), checked 24 September 2026. This draft is not a legal opinion; any menu wording or service procedure requires current legal and rabbinic review.

Article 1א states the purpose. In the Hebrew of that text: מטרתו של חוק זה לאפשר לצרכן של מצרכים שמבקש לשמור על דיני הכשרות ומנהגיה להסתמך על תעודת הכשר, ולמנוע הטעיה. Rendered in English for this draft, not as an official translation: the purpose of this law is to let a consumer of products who wishes to keep the laws and customs of kashrut rely on a certificate, and to prevent deception. A sealed plate with a story that is not the certificate's story betrays that purpose. So does a room that borrows the plate's certificate for itself.

Article 2, as now written, lists who may give a certificate for the purposes of the law. For an imported product, the Council of the Chief Rabbinate, or a rabbi it has authorized under the conditions the article states. For a food establishment, a place of slaughter, or the place of manufacture of a product, the local rabbi serving in the place where they are, or the Council of the Chief Rabbinate; and if no local rabbi is serving, or he is unable to perform this role, a rabbi the Council has authorized, provided he is a member of the Council or a public employee who is a rabbi in Israel. For the army, the Chief Rabbi of the army or a military rabbi he has authorized. The Hebrew of the manufacture clause, article 2(2), begins: לעניין בית אוכל, מקום שחיטה או מקום הייצור של מצרך או של מוצר – רב מקומי המכהן במקום שבו הם נמצאים או מועצת הרבנות הראשית. A kitchen that produces a sealed dish is, in this structure, a place of manufacture. The certificate the statute contemplates is the local rabbi's, or the Council's, at that place. This draft does not decide that a particular council's certificate, on a particular day, satisfies a particular guest. It decides only that the project will not invent a fourth kind of issuer.

Article 11 says that in giving a certificate, the person authorized to give it shall take into account the laws of kashrut alone. The considerations of a brand, a market, or a mixed table are not, in that sentence, reasons for issuing a certificate. They may be reasons for a restaurant to buy a plate that already has one. They are not reasons to print a new one.

The Israel Democracy Institute's 2024 report, already cited, summarizes a 2017 High Court holding in its legal background to the kashrut chapter: a business without an official certificate may not present any kashrut representation, and the owner may present a true account of the standards he keeps and of how they are supervised. The report gives the year 2017 and does not, in the passage read here, give the day. This draft does not add a day from elsewhere. The practical memory of that holding, for this project, is a warning about the word kosher placed on the wrong noun. A true sentence about a sealed dish is one kind of speech. A representation that the house is kosher is another. The 1983 statute as amended in 2026 is the text this draft uses for what is prohibited. The 2017 holding is cited only as the Institute reports it.

Tzohar appears in that same legal background as a body founded in 2018, after the holding, and as a body giving certificates as an alternative to the rabbinate's array rather than as a second storey on top of it. As of September 2024, the Institute says, according to data received from the organization, Tzohar supervised 334 businesses and separately mentions 15 wineries, with 38 supervisors and 4 overseers. Its regional figures — 90 in the Shephelah and south, 84 in the center, 73 in the north and Sharon, 72 in Jerusalem — add to 319, not 334. The source does not resolve this difference; this draft does not assign the missing 15 to a category. The trust figures were given in Part I. They are enough to show a contested seal. This project does not become Tzohar, does not sell Tzohar's name, and does not treat Tzohar's existence as permission to found a cousin of it.

The restaurant does not become kosher

The statute separates, in its prohibitions, the food establishment from the product. The separation is visible in the text. Whether a particular line of menu type falls on one side or the other is a question this draft leaves with a lawyer. The market dossier already left it there. No lawyer has answered it for this project. The pages below are a reading of the sections, so that the business can be seen against them. They are not an opinion letter.

A food establishment, בית אוכל, is defined in article 1 as a place engaged in sale to the public of products, or in serving them, for eating or drinking on the premises, and also a butcher shop; for a hotel, the parts of the hotel where products are prepared or served for eating or drinking on the premises.

Article 3(א): בעל בית אוכל לא יציג בכתב את בית האוכל ככשר, אלא אם כן ניתנה לו תעודת הכשר. The owner of a food establishment shall not present the establishment in writing as kosher unless a certificate has been given to him.

Article 3(ב): בעל בית אוכל שבידו תעודת הכשר ובית האוכל מוצג בכתב ככשר, לא יגיש ולא ימכור בו מצרכים שלא ניתנה בעדם תעודת הכשר. An owner who holds a certificate, and whose establishment is presented in writing as kosher, shall not serve or sell in it products for which no certificate was given.

Article 4(א): יצרן של מוצר לא יציין על מוצר שייצר או על אריזתו כי הוא כשר ולא יציגו ככשר בפרסום או בדרך אחרת, אלא אם כן ניתנה לו תעודת הכשר. A manufacturer shall not mark a product he made, or its packaging, as kosher, and shall not present it as kosher in advertising or in another way, unless a certificate has been given to him.

Article 4(ב) says the manufacturer who was given a certificate for a product shall not market a product for which no certificate was given while marking it as kosher.

Article 5: העוסק במכירת מצרכים לציבור לא ימכור ולא יציע למכירה מוצר שלא ניתנה בעדו תעודת הכשר תוך הצגתו בכתב ככשר. One who sells products to the public shall not sell, and shall not offer for sale, a product for which no certificate was given, while presenting it in writing as kosher.

Article 6 is a defense. In a prosecution under articles 3, 4, or 5, it is a good defense that the accused, in good faith, sold or served a product for which a certificate had been given, or used a component for which a certificate had been given. The defense covers a person who relied on a real certificate. It does not repair a broken seal, and it does not cover a product that never had a certificate.

Article 9(א) tells the manufacturer or importer of a product that bears a kosher mark not to sell it, and not to offer it for sale, unless he has noted on the product the name of the authorized rabbi who gave the certificate, and, if a standard symbol was set, unless the product bears the symbol set in the certificate. Article 2(ו) allows the Chief Rabbinate Council to set a symbol for each kashrut standard it regulates, and says that if it sets one, the symbol shall include a reference to the product being dairy, meat, or pareve. The official amendment published on 19 July 2026 (Book of Laws 3548, amendment 5, section 36(2)) expressly replaces the old reference to “the supervisor” (להוראות הממונה) in article 9(b) with “the certificate of kosher approval” (לתעודת ההכשר). The earlier apparent tension with the deleted definition of הממונה is therefore not a current textual conflict. If no standard symbol has been set, the dairy, meat, or pareve marking must follow the certificate as amended. See https://fs.knesset.gov.il/25/law/25_lsr_14184767.pdf, printed p. 789. This is a reading of the published text, not an opinion on how a proposed restaurant service would be approved. What remains clear enough to operate is this: the name of the authorized rabbi belongs on the product that carries the kosher mark, and the dairy, meat, or pareve character belongs in the symbol regime the text describes. Those marks are the manufacturer's to print, because article 9 addresses the manufacturer and the importer. The restaurant does not invent them at the pass.

Article 14, as amended in the תשפ"ו text: העובר עבירה לפי סעיפים 3 עד 5, 7, 7א, 9 או 10, דינו – מאסר שנה. One who commits an offense under articles 3 to 5, 7, 79, א, or 10 is liable to one year of imprisonment. Article 15 extends exposure, in the circumstances it states, to an active manager, a partner other than a limited partner, or a senior administrative employee of a corporation, unless that person proves the offense was committed without his knowledge and that he took all reasonable steps to ensure the law was kept. The word "partner" in that article is the statute's word for a business partner in a violating corporation. It is not a word this draft uses for any kitchen or any restaurant. No such relation exists here.

The reading that follows is the reading already in the market dossier, repeated so that this memorandum can stand on its own. Article 3 speaks about presenting the establishment. Articles 4 and 5 speak about the product: the manufacturer marking it, and the seller offering it in writing as kosher. A non-kosher restaurant that wants to sell a sealed dish stays inside the second pair only if the writing is about the dish, and only if the dish in fact has a certificate. The restaurant does not present itself, in writing, as kosher. It does not present its kitchen, its oven, or its card as kosher. The line names the dish, the producing kitchen, and the certificate already given to that production. Whether a phrase such as "kosher option," printed on the card of an uncertified room, would be read by an inspector or a court as a presentation of the establishment under article 3(א), rather than of the product under article 5, is the lawyer's question. This draft does not write the menu line. It says the line waits for that advice, and for the certificate, and for the rabbi's handling rule. Until then, no public sentence says the dish is kosher.

What fits the text, once a real certificate is in force, is ordinary and strict. The restaurant buys the closed dish, holds it cold and apart, and offers it as one line. The line tells the truth the seal tells. The guest opens. Article 6 is the defense of the person who, in good faith, served a product that had a certificate. What does not fit is a sentence that the house is kosher; a seal opened and then repaired with the house's food; a warmed dish whose warming the certifying rabbi has not allowed; a broken cold chain still served under the word; a Saturday service of the line while the question of Shabbat is unanswered; a Pesach service under a certificate that does not say Pesach.

The guest's trust has the same shape. The room is not kosher because the container is. If this certificate is not enough for that guest at home, it is not enough here. The draft does not rename a rabbinic certificate to make it sound stricter. The Institute's figures in Part I are why. People who insist on a specific badatz will not be persuaded by a sentence in a memorandum. They should not be addressed as if they will.

Sorotzkin, as stated on their public site

Sorotzkin is not a partner of this project. No agreement exists. No one was written to, and no one was called, for this draft. The paragraphs below report what their public site stated when it was read on 23 September 2026. They are included because the business needs an example of a kitchen that already says, in public, that it holds a certificate, and because the repository's design notes already point at this site as a kitchen under consideration, not as a partnership. Consideration is not a relation. The site's own words are the limit of what this draft knows.

The homepage title, on that reading, was: עמוד הבית - סורוצקין - מעדנייה יהודית כשרה - משלוחים ומגשי אירוח. In English: a home page of Sorotzkin, a kosher Jewish deli, deliveries and hosting trays. Latin lettering on the page includes the name Sorotzkin, on a gift card and in a software credit. The page is a shop of prepared foods, bakery, salads, mains, pots, sweets, drinks, and packages, including packages described as hosting for Shabbat.

The questions page states, in answer to whether the deli is kosher: כן. המעדנייה כשרה בהשגחת הרבנות פתח תקווה. Yes. The deli is kosher under the supervision of the Petah Tikva rabbinic. That is their sentence. It is not a sentence this project can print on a restaurant card, because this project does not hold their certificate, and they have not agreed to supply a single dish. It is evidence of what a public kitchen can already say about itself.

The same page states that there is a minimum order of 199 shekels, not including delivery. It states delivery prices of 49 shekels for the north and the south, 44 shekels for the Sharon and Jerusalem, and 39 shekels for the center. It states that deliveries run from 6:00 in the morning until 19:30, and that the courier makes contact the evening before with a narrower window. It states that they deliver to the cities and towns between Beer Sheva in the south and Nahariya in the north. It states that the deli has no physical shop where the food can be bought, and that it works by delivery only. It states that self-pickup is possible by prior arrangement with customer service. Those are household-delivery terms, as published. They are not a wholesale price for a restaurant, and this draft does not convert them into one. Prices of individual packages also appear on the homepage. They are not copied here, because a scrape of labels on a single morning is a poor way to fix a price list, and because this memorandum is not an order form.

No telephone number, no email address, and no social-media handle is printed in this draft. The questions page refers a reader to customer service for pickup. The about page invites a person who has eaten to post a story and tag the dish. The existence of those channels is noted. The channels themselves are not reproduced. This draft does not use them.

The about page states a shared love of food that is home. It says their dream was to bring the tastiest food to the reader's house, with no difference of community or sector. It says the deli's food is the food eaten in their house on Shabbat. It says they grew up in the most different worlds, and that in both houses food was the center: food is home, family, memory. It says that in the home they established when they married in 2018,

food is the foundation, and that they wanted to make food like a mother's, only tastier. It names קורין גרעון as a television host who grew up in a secular home, one of three children. It names חילי סורוצקין as a businessman in textiles who grew up in a Haredi home, one of fourteen children, and the page itself says the fourteen is not a typing error. It includes a heading תעודת כשרות, "kashrut certificate," and a heading for delivery home timed for the Friday table. The sentence that names the supervising rabbinate, on the day of this reading, is the sentence on the questions page, quoted above. The about page also prints ואכלת ושבעת ותינת. That is their wording. It is a play. It is not Deuteronomy 8:10, which says eat, be satisfied, and bless the LORD your God for the good land. Their line is recorded so that it will not be mistaken for the verse, and so that their story — two houses, one of them secular and one of them Haredi, food as the shared center — can be heard as theirs.

That story is the closest public sentence, on a site read for this draft, to the table Part I could not quantify. Two people from different Jewish worlds, married in 2018, state that food is the basis of the house they made. They do not state, on the pages read, that they measure the national share of couples who keep different kashrut. They do not state that they supply non-kosher restaurants. They do not state that a restaurant may call itself kosher because it holds their container. They state a deli, a rabbinate, a delivery map, and a house. This draft takes them at that word, and no further.

Sources, all read 23 September 2026:

- Homepage, jewishdeli.co.il
- About, עלינו
- Questions, שאלות ותשובות

What remains to be signed, and by whom

David Amor and Leeya Katz are the people for whom the signature lines were drawn. David's question has been set in Part II with its source identified. This part does not turn the sentence into a term of trade. A restaurant does not buy "love." A restaurant may buy a closed dish, at a price this draft does not invent, if the seal is real and the line is honest and the dish is good enough to sit beside the house's own plate. The price, the volume, and the number of rooms are absent because they have no URL. When a real certificate, a real kitchen, and a real lawyer's sentence exist, a later paper can carry numbers that are quotes and contracts. This paper carries the structure those quotes would have to respect.

The structure, once more, in the order a guest would meet it. The restaurant remains a non-kosher restaurant. One line is a closed dish. The certificate on the dish is the certificate of the kitchen that made it, from a body that already certifies, under a name the statute can recognize. The guest opens the seal. The friends eat the card they came for. Shabbat and Pesach are not assumed. The word kosher is not spoken of the house. If any of those sentences fails, the line is withdrawn. There is no public paragraph of repair that asks the guest to trust a broken seal.

David's question can be heard again, now that the business has been stated in full.

How love brings Torah to a generation, it starts at the restaurant.

It remains David's question, rendered provisionally in English. The restaurant, in the business just described, is a place where love could refuse a split table without refusing Torah's distinctions or pretending the house has become something else. Whether a generation actually receives Torah this way is unproven. Leeya Katz has not approved this formulation. The lines at the front are empty, and the draft is not signed.

No participant is presented as a partner; this draft records no agreed partnership. No address, telephone, or inbox is given, because this draft asks nothing of anyone it has not been asked, by its authors, to approach. It is a memorandum for two signatures, and then, only if they wish, for the slower work of a real certificate and a real room.

Sources for every figure

Each figure in the draft is repeated here with the place it was taken from. Years are the years the source itself uses, plus the date this draft read the page, 23 September 2026, where the source is a webpage or a file fetched that day.

Central Bureau of Statistics, 17 September 2025, PDF, release 304/2025, with a file note of a data update on 15 February 2026. Eve of Rosh Hashanah 5786: population of Israel about 10.148 million; about 7.758 million "Jews and others" (78.5 percent of Israelis); about 2.130 million Arabs (21.5 percent); about 260 thousand foreigners. "Others" as defined in the release. Data cover about 11.75 months; population figures provisional, based on the 2022 census. End of 2024, in the same release: population more than 10 million; Israelis about 9.811 million; "Jews and others" about 7.707 million (78.6 percent); Arabs about 2.104 million (21.4 percent); foreigners about 260.9 thousand. Jews aged 20 and over, self-defined religiosity, presented in that end-of-2024 section: secular, not religious, 42.7 percent; traditional, not so religious, 21.5 percent; traditional-religious, 12.0 percent; religious, 12.0 percent; Haredi, 11.4 percent.

Pew Research Center, 8 March 2016, fieldwork October 2014–May 2015. Overview, [israels-religiously-divided-society](#): Haredi 9 percent of Jews, 8 percent of adults; Dati 13 percent of Jews, 10 percent of adults; Masorti 29 percent of Jews, 23 percent of adults; Hiloni 49 percent of Jews, 40 percent of adults. Married Haredim, 95 percent say the spouse is Haredi. Hilonim with a spouse or partner, 93 percent say that person is Hiloni. Datiim, 85 percent say the spouse is Dati. Married Masortim, 64 percent married to another Masorti; 20 percent to a Dati; 15 percent to a Hiloni. Two percent of married Jews say the spouse belongs to a non-Jewish religion or is religiously unaffiliated. One percent of married Muslim, Christian, and Druze respondents say the spouse has a different religion. Close friends: 48 percent of Masortim say all or most are Masortim; roughly nine in ten Haredim and Hilonim say all or most belong to the same subgroup; 72 percent of Datiim say all or most are Datiim. Practices chapter, [jewish-beliefs-and-practices](#): keep kosher outside the home 52 percent, in the home 63 percent; Masortim at home 86 percent; Hilonim at home 33 percent, and 63 percent do not; outside, all Haredim and Datiim in the survey, Masortim 69 percent, Hilonim about one in five. Pork: 16 percent eat it, 82 percent do not; 67 percent of Hilonim refrain. Outside the home, Sephardi or Mizrahi ancestry 70 percent, Ashkenazi 35 percent. Children of former-Soviet-Union immigrants against their parents: kosher at home 50 percent against 24 percent; outside 35 percent against 19 percent. Russian spoken at home: 47 percent eat pork, 49 percent refrain.

Israel Democracy Institute, December 2024, PDF. Survey of September 2024: 1,211 respondents aged 18 and over; 1,001 Jews; 210 Arab citizens; maximum sampling error 2.82 percent overall, 3.1 percent for Jews, 6.76 percent for Arabs. Careful about kosher food: 68 percent to some degree; 45 percent always; 23 percent usually; 2022 biennial almost identical. Eating out: 35.5 percent only with a certificate they trust; 19.5 percent by their own understanding or the owner's statement even without a certificate; 45 percent do not check. Secular: 85 percent no interest in a certificate or a statement. Traditional, not religious: 21 percent insist on a certificate; 44 percent by understanding or the owner's statement. Among those who insist on a certificate: 47 percent any rabbinic certificate; 18.5 percent mehadrin or specific rabbinates; 23.5 percent only specific badatz authorities. Haredi who insist: 2 percent all rabbinic certificates; 12 percent specific rabbinic certificates. National-religious who insist: 87 percent a rabbinic certificate (59 percent all local rabbinates, 28 percent mehadrin or specific). Traditional-religious who insist: 90.5 percent a rabbinic certificate (71 percent all local, 19.5 percent mehadrin or specific). Traditional, not religious, who require a certificate: 82 percent all local rabbinates; 13.5 percent mehadrin or specific. Tzohar, among those who insist: 27 percent trust, against 37 percent in the 2022 survey; Haredi rejection described as complete; traditional-religious who insist, 29 percent trust Tzohar; national-religious who insist, 47 percent trust Tzohar; with the "own understanding" group added, 51 percent of national-religious respondents trust Tzohar. Certificates issued by religious councils: 14,423 businesses in 2022, up 5.4 percent from 13,683 in 2020; catering and hospitality 8,400 businesses, 58 percent; food manufacturing 25 percent; food retail 17 percent. Geographic stock of kosher businesses, 2022: 43.5 percent in the center (26.5 percent Central district, 17 percent Tel Aviv district); South 17 percent; Jerusalem and Judea and Samaria 16 percent. Catering businesses kosher, 2019 analysis, republished 2024, with a pointer to Finkelstein and Abensour 2021: about 66 percent in Israel, as an estimate the report offers; 90 percent in the Jerusalem and Judea and Samaria district; 49 percent in the Tel Aviv district. Shabbat openings as stated in that report for the Tel Aviv district: 23 cultural halls and theaters, 79 percent of the district's; all 11 recognized museums; 31 pools, 97 percent open. Tzohar scale, data the Institute says it received from the organization, as of September 2024: total reported 334 businesses; reported regional breakdown 90 Shephelah and south + 84 center + 73 north and Sharon + 72 Jerusalem = 319; 15 wineries also mentioned separately; 38 supervisors, 4 overseers. The discrepancy of 15 between the published total and regional breakdown remains unresolved in the source. The report dates Tzohar's kashrut body to 2018.

Knesset national legislation record, checked 24 September 2026, the 1983 law and Amendment No. 5, published 19 July 2026; see also the **Knesset announcement**. Article 14 sets a one-year imprisonment term for the offenses it lists. The legal analysis in Part III is provisional and requires current counsel review.

Sorotzkin public site, read 23 September 2026. Married in 2018, as the about page states. One of three children; one of fourteen children. Minimum order 199 shekels, not including delivery. Delivery 49, 44, and 39 shekels for the regions the questions page names. Deliveries from 6:00 to 19:30. The URLs are in Part III.

Not found, and not replaced. The share of couples who do not keep the same kashrut. A current count of non-kosher restaurants in the city of Tel Aviv. A sourced rate of restaurants open on Shabbat. Any price, wage, or volume for this project. The companion research audit records the same gaps.

OU Kosher, checked 24 September 2026, *The Kosher Primer*, travel section. Describes double-wrapped certified meals with intact caterer and rabbinic seals on planes, trains, and ships; certification applies to the sealed food, not other food served by a carrier. It does not approve this project's proposed restaurant service.

Verses cited

Forty-four verses are quoted in Part II, each in the 1917 JPS translation checked on Sefaria on 23 September 2026. The version page for any one of them is the version titled *The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation (JPS 1917)*. An entry point is [Sefaria, JPS 1917, Genesis 18:2&lang=bi](#)). The forty-four are:

1. Genesis 18:2
2. Genesis 18:3
3. Genesis 18:4
4. Genesis 18:5
5. Genesis 18:6
6. Genesis 18:7
7. Genesis 18:8
8. Genesis 19:1
9. Genesis 19:2
10. Genesis 19:3
11. Genesis 24:17
12. Genesis 24:18
13. Genesis 24:19
14. Genesis 43:32
15. Exodus 23:9
16. Exodus 23:19
17. Exodus 34:26
18. Leviticus 11:2
19. Leviticus 11:46
20. Leviticus 11:47
21. Leviticus 19:9
22. Leviticus 19:10
23. Leviticus 19:18
24. Leviticus 19:33
25. Leviticus 19:34
26. Deuteronomy 8:10
27. Deuteronomy 10:18
28. Deuteronomy 10:19
29. Deuteronomy 14:3
30. Deuteronomy 14:21
31. Deuteronomy 16:14
32. Ruth 2:14
33. I Kings 17:12

34. I Kings 17:13
35. I Kings 17:15
36. II Kings 4:8
37. II Kings 4:9
38. II Kings 4:10
39. Isaiah 58:7
40. Micah 6:8
41. Psalms 23:5
42. Psalms 128:3
43. Proverbs 15:17
44. Job 31:32

No other verse is cited. No midrash is cited. David Amor's question is not in this list.

Draft. Not yet signed.

Prepared for the signature of David Amor and Leeya Katz.